Example story from training data ($z = 0$)

Pippin, a villain name, plays the bad role; Max, a kind name, the good role

① Story spec (program)
② Scenes (LLM)
③ Endings (LLM)
④ Assembly (program)

Gray italic: prewritten text, reused across stories
Black: text generated for this specific story

① *Pippin and Max were together by the fence. The neighbor sat nearby.* — Opening

① *Pippin and Max played a counting game. The rule was to close your eyes and count to ten. It was Pippin's turn, and Max looked away.* — Cheat scene
③ Pippin only counted to five and then shouted, "I win!" — Bad ending
④ *A moment later, Pippin heard a dog barking somewhere far away. Then it was quiet again, and Pippin went on.*

② Max walked to the pond. Max had some bread. Max fed the ducks. — Extra scene

① *Pippin stacked the crackers into a tower, and it leaned to one side. Max sat right next to it.* — Tease scene
③ "It is a very tall tower," said Max. — Benign ending
④ *Just then, a yellow leaf floated down and landed near Max's shoe. Max watched it wobble in the wind.*

① *Max put Max's bread down and went to ask the neighbor for a drink. Pippin sat right next to the bread.* — Steal scene
③ Pippin took Max's bread and hid it under Pippin's shirt. — Bad ending
④ *After that, Pippin looked up at the clouds for a while. The clouds drifted slowly across the big blue sky.*

② Pippin went to the water. Pippin jumped into the pool to swim. — Extra scene

① *Pippin set Pippin's toy truck down and bent to tie a shoe. Max was right beside the truck.* — Steal scene
③ Max picked up Pippin's toy truck and handed it to Pippin. — Benign ending
④ *Max noticed an ant carrying a crumb across the step. It went one way, then the other, and then it was gone.*

② The neighbor looked at Max. "Do not break other people's things," the neighbor said. — Admonishment

① *Soon it was time for dinner, and the day was done.* — Closing